open source platform. "We incorporated the feedback from Project Brillo to include familiar tools such as Android Studio, the Android Software Development Kit (SDK), Google Play Services and Google Cloud Platform," stated Piekarski.

Google announced Project Brillo as its initial IoT platform at the I/O developer conference in 2015. This will now be a part of Android Things.

On the hardware front, Google has partnered with some manufacturers for innovations such as Intel Edison, NXP Pico and Raspberry Pi 3. This strategic move will enable these device makers to integrate Android Things support into their hardware.

Alongside the latest Android platform for IoT devices, Google has announced an update to its Weave platform. The new release is aimed "to make it easier for all types of devices to connect to the cloud" and enhance existing services such as Google Assistant.

It is worth noting that Google's Weave is already a part of devices under the Philips Hue and Samsung SmartThings line-up. Thus, it is powering not just the hardware that has Android support but many smart devices like light bulbs, smart plugs and switches.

Google is also set to merge Weave with Nest Weave to give developers a unified way to enter the world of IoT.

Developers can access documentation and code samples for Android Things and the updated Weave directly from their respective websites. Moreover, a specific IoT developers' community is available on Google+ to offer real-time support to those who need it.

Google Keyboard now becomes Gboard on Android

Google has replaced the default keyboard app on Android with its Gboard. Initially available on iOS, the virtual keyboard is designed to support hardware apart from Nexus and Pixel devices.

Taking on SwiftKey, Gboard delivers an advanced typing experience on the open source Android platform.

It supports GIFs as well as Google Search integration. Additionally, there is an option to search for new emojis.

There is a dedicated G button on the keyboard that gives you direct access to Google Search. For large-screen devices, the keyboard has a one-handed mode. You can also use the built-in emoji options to express your feelings through some attractive emoticons.

Besides this, the basics of the original Google Keyboard remain in Gboard. There are features like auto-predict and glide typing to ease texting on the virtual keyboard.

Google is yet to enable separate Gboard access for developers. Meanwhile, you can use it on your Android devices by downloading an APK file. The keyboard is expected to reach the Google Play store soon.

Kubernetes v1.5 adds support for Windows server containers

Kubernetes has received a new update. The version 1.5 comes with native support for Windows server containers and is designed to run a distributed database.

The Google team behind Kubernetes is aiming to help .NET developers with the latest release. This is the reason Kubernetes 1.5 enables initial support for Windows Server 2016 nodes and scheduling Windows server containers. This support is likely to get better over time, as developers are expected to give feedback on areas for improvement.

The support for Windows containers is big news for the open source world after Amazon Web Services entered the container management market with Blox. Amazon's offering might face stiff competition from Kubernetes.

Apart from the Windows container support, the updated Kubernetes has Kubefed that comes as a new command-line tool to help you manage multi-cluster federations at once. You can also use StatefulSet to manage pods in a smarter way.

StatefulSet beta allows persistent identity and per-instance storage workloads to be created, scaled, deleted and repaired right on Kubernetes. Also, it eases the deployment of stateful services and provides tutorial examples.

The new Kubernetes also comes preloaded with the first version of the Container Runtime Interface (CRI) API to enable pluggable container runtimes. The platform also includes a beta version of the Node conformance test.

You can download Kubernetes 1.5 on your system directly from its online repository on GitHub. It is also available through get.k8s.io.

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